Guidelines for Ministerial Education and Guidance and Ministerial Appointments Committee Reports

The following pages give guidance for MEG and MAC reports.

General Guidance

- When possible information should be reported on the MAC report or the MEG report, but not both. This encourages clarity and consistency.
- There is no specific format required for MEG or MAC reports. A suggested report order is given, but is not a requirement. The items listed on the following pages are not meant to exclude additional information, but are a starting point that lists the data required for proper reporting.
- The listed status changes on the MEG report comprise a complete list. Each action taken by the MEG or recommended to the Annual Conference relating to minister status should be one of the actions listed.
- The listed appointments for ministers comprise a complete list. Ministers should be appointed to one of the listed appointments, and no others.

Ministerial Status

- Any elder without another specified status is assumed to be an Member in Good Standing and eligible for active ministry. Every Elder who is a Member in Good Standing should have an appointment made for them by the MAC from the appointments listed later in this document.
- Elders at times may be suspended. Elders under investigation or under Covenant of Restoration may be suspended for the duration. Other reasons may also call for suspension of an elder. The appointments of any elder are revoked immediately upon their suspension.
- Elders may also be located, giving up their conference membership and become members of a local Free Methodist congregation. Located Elders may be returned to itinerant ministry by MEG or AC action.
- Elders may be returned to Lay status. Their membership in the conference and all appointments are revoked, and they are no longer clergy in the FMCUSA.

The MEG report is split into two main parts.

- First, the MEG recommends actions to the Annual Conference. These are then approved by the Annual Conference while in session and enacted if passed.
- Second, the MEG reports actions that have already taken effect. This section includes any actions the MEG has taken on behalf of the AC while it was not in session. (any actions with an effective date prior to AC) This report is voted on and approved by the AC, affirming the reported actions.

The MAC report should be a list of appointments grouped by type.

- There are 11 different appointments that can be made by the MAC. Each appointment must be one of those 11 listed appointments.
- Deacons should only be included if they were ordained as Deacon prior to GC1999. If they were ordained prior to 1999, then they *must* be included.
- Deacons received after GC 1999 are not members of the conference and are not appointed by the MAC.
- Any minister may be appointed more than once, if appropriate. For instance, they may be appointed to Conference Service as a District Superintendent and to a Local Church Appointment as pastor.

Ministerial Education and Guidance Board Report

The [CONFRENCE NAME] Ministerial Education and Guidance Board recommends:
-OR- Further, the [CONFRENCE NAME] Ministerial Education and Guidance Board reports:
(Actions taken effective at Annual Conference are recommended for AC approval. Actions taken by the MEG with an effective date before Annual Conference are reported for confirmation by the AC. For more detail, see the Pastor's and Church Leaders Manual, the MEG manual, or the Book of Discipline.

1. **MEG or AC action taken:**
   a. *Admitted into Full Membership and Ordained Elder* - A minister is admitted at AC as Elder.
   b. *Received as Conference Ministerial Candidate* - A minister is received at AC as CMCs.
   c. *Reinstated as Conference Ministerial Candidate* - A minister who had been a CMCs, was discontinued, and is again received as CMC.
   d. *Admitted as Licensed Pastor* - A minister is approved by the MEG or AC to serve as Licensed Pastor.
   e. *Granted Certificate of Standing with View to Transfer* - A minister is approved by MEG or AC to transfer to another conference or denomination.
   f. *Received by Transfer* - A minister is approved by the MEG or AC to transfer in from another conference or denomination.
   g. *Returned to Lay Status* - Elders or Ordained Deacons are removed and no longer members of the conference.
   h. *Withdrawn from Conference and Denomination* - An Elder withdraws without specific relevant circumstances.
   i. *Withdrawn from Conference and Denomination with Permission Under Charges or Complaints* - An Elder withdraws while charges or complaints are in process against them.
   j. *Withdrawn from Conference and Denomination at Own Request* - An Elder withdraws at their own request without charges or complaints against them.
   k. *Discontinued as Conference Ministerial Candidate* - A CMC is discontinued by MEG or AC action.
   l. *Discontinued as Licensed Pastor* - A Licensed Pastor is no longer authorized by the MEG or AC.
   m. *Credentials Placed on Deposit with the Conference Office* - Credentials are returned to the conference office after ministerial status has changed.
   n. *Credentials Declared Null and Void* - Credentials are not turned in but are no longer valid.
   o. *Restoration of Credentials* - Credentials are returned or reissued to a minister.
   p. *Suspended* - A minister is temporarily removed from membership in good standing.
   q. *Located* - A minister becomes a member of a local congregation and is no longer a member of the conference, retaining their status as Elder.
   r. *Reinstated to Itinerant Service* - A minister is restored to itinerant service after suspension or location.
   s. *Deceased* - A minister has passed away.

2. **Affirmed the character of appointed ministers:**

The Ministerial Education and Guidance Board has given due consideration to the integrity and Christian discipleship of each ministerial member of the [CONFERENCE NAME]. Based on the information available to the MEG Board through the ministers' confidential annual reports and input from the Superintendent, to the best of their knowledge, the MEG Board recommends passing on the integrity and Christian discipleship of each in accord with Para 5310 of the 2023 Book of Discipline. *(In this section, also list any active Covenants of Restoration for elders in the conference.)*

3. **Affirmed the character and discipleship of located ministers:**

Upon recommendation by the various pastors and local boards of administration of the churches where they are located, the Ministerial Education and Guidance Board affirms the integrity and Christian discipleship of located deacons and elders. (Para 5700.E 2023 Book of Discipline)

4. **List of those continued as Conference Ministerial Candidates**

5. **List of those continued as Licensed Pastors**

Ministerial Appointments Committee Report

Each year, an appointment must be reported for each Elder, CMC, and Licensed Pastor in the conference. Ordained Deacons (those ordained by the bishop prior to the changes in 1999) should also be reported. Deacons received more recently than 1999 are not conference members and should not be listed on the MAC report.

Each active minister in good standing must have at least one appointment from section 2 below. Each minister may be under more than one appointment. For instance, one may be appointed as both a district superintendent in Conference Service and also be appointed to a Local Church Appointment. *For more detail, see the Pastor's & Church Leaders Manual, the MEG manual, or the Book of Discipline.*

1. For each appointment, the following should be reported:

a. *Effective Date*
b. *Minister Name*
c. *Minister ID*
d. *Ordination Status of Minister* (Elder, CMC, Licensed Pastor, or Deacon)
e. *Appointment Made* (see section 2)
f. *Role or Title* (see section 3)
g. *Organization/Church Name* (if relevant)
h. *Church ID* (if appointed to an FMCUSA church)

2. Each appointment made by the MAC should be one of the following:

a. *Local Church Appointment* for any minister appointed in ministry to an Society, Fellowship, Affiliated Congregation, or Church Plant.
b. *Located Elder* for any elders located to a particular local church and are no longer engaged in itinerant ministry. If a minister is located, that should be their only appointment.
c. *Located Deacon* should only be used for Deacons ordained prior to 1999.
d. *Under the Superintendent* is used when a congregation does not have a lead pastor appointed to them.
e. *Conference Service* is appropriate for conference evangelists, superintendents and assistant superintendents, administrative staff, or those appointed to congregations that are not yet registered as FMCUSA churches. This appointment is to the conference, not a local FMCUSA church.
f. *Released for Denominational Service* appropriate for FMWM missionaries, those working at the World Ministries Center, or others in service to the FMCUSA outside the conference.
g. *Released for Ministry Outside the Denomination* is to be used when the minister is in active ministry outside the context of the FMCUSA.
h. *Retired* for those ministers who are retired and not itinerant.
i. *Awaiting Appointment* to be used when a minister stands ready to be appointed, but the MAC has not appointed them to specific ministry.
j. *Granted Leave of Absence* for ministers who have requested not to be appointed to ministry.
k. *Temporarily Unavailable for Appointment* for ministers whose current life situation is incompatible with ministry and who intend to return when their situation changes. (attending school, paternity leave, etc.)

3. Each minister with one of the following roles in the local church should be listed as:

a. *LP* – lead pastor or co-lead pastor
b. *IP* – Interim Pastor
c. *WP* – worship pastor
d. *YP* – youth or children pastor
e. *AP* – Associate or Assistant Pastor
f. Others may be left blank or another title may be listed.